



GABE NEWELL

Abilities: Gaming evangelist, USD \$1.2 billion net worth, Creator of Portal
XP Points: 51 year old, Played Super Mario and Doom on Burroughs Mainframe (Geek cred)
Achievement Unlocked: "Microsoft Millionaire". PC gaming lord and saviour.
Quote: "C'mon, people, you can't show the player a really big bomb and not let them blow it up."

1 If you've been getting whooped on any MMORPG on Steam by Rabscuttle feel honoured. You've just been killed by one of the most revered and definitely most innovative persons on the gaming scene. Gabe Logan Newell is the co-creator and managing director of Valve Corporation, the company that brought us titles like Half Life and Portal. He also handles the online distribution side of the business - Yes - Steam. After winning it big with his software producing gig for Microsoft, he began his personal quest to change gaming in 1996. Gabe is more than just gaming management but a majority owner of the Valve Corporation and its decisions reverberate with his personality and philosophy. The industry renowned troll ninja of the forums, Gabe is the father of what is sure to become the future of gaming - Steam Machine. Having revolutionised the online distribution and revenue model with Steam since its initial release in 2003, Gabe is now intent on making Linux the backbone of gaming and the Steam Machine endeavour. He can also be found hitting it old school on YouTube with "Stop a Gaben" remix video.



ELON MUSK

Abilities: Visionary, Inventor,
XP Points: 42 year old, midwifed eBooks industry, USD \$ 9.1 Billion net worth
Achievement Unlocked: Electric Cars, PayPal, Space Travel, Reminded everyone how cool Tesla is
Quote: "I've said I want to die on Mars. Just not on impact."

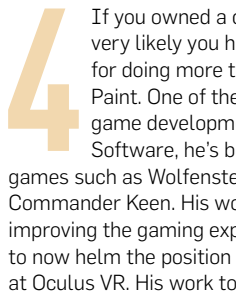
2 As a boy he taught himself programming and coded a game for sale at the age of 12. After selling his software company Zip2 to Compaq (HP) in 1999 for 22 million dollars, he started his next venture PayPal almost immediately. Within three years he had sold it to eBay for USD 1.5 billion, of which his personal share was 165 million dollars. He was 31, just getting started. He's moved beyond software now and after a youth littered with degrees in Economics and Physics (Wharton School) with some dabbling around in the Applied Physics department at Stanford (PhD dropout), it seems only natural that Musk now does what he was meant to do - solve the energy crisis, improve the environment and conquer space. Or at least make space within reach of citizens, not only governments. With projects like Tesla Motors and Hyperloop to his credit, why can't we please throw a few Nobel prizes at him already?



JEFF BEZOS

Abilities: Entrepreneur, Innovator, Space Geek
XP Points: 50 year old, Clock of the Long Now, USD \$28 Billion net worth
Achievement Unlocked: Amazon, Space Travel, Tried dismantling his crib as a baby.
Quote: "What's dangerous is not to evolve."

3 Jeff Bezos is part of the select few people in history who make paradigm shifting changes. He hasn't done this through science and technology alone, but by understanding what people want. And then giving it to them. And instead of opting for baser items like fast food and risqué entertainment he gave them an easy access to books in the digital world. His idea for an online book store in the early nineties gave birth to Amazon.com, the world's largest online store for books. Since his initial ideation on a cross country drive across America, Bezos has made Amazon not just a place for digital purchases but evolved the way books are owned and experienced through the creation of the Amazon Kindle. After having irrevocably changed the way people shop, read and experience the digital life, Bezos has set his sights even higher - to the stars. With a youth spent in school and college groups about space exploration and development, Jeff Bezos started Blue Origin with the intention of making it possible for "anybody to go to space". Cool.



JOHN CARMACK

Abilities: Game design, rocket development, VR futurist
XP Points: 43 year old, Wolfenstein 3D, Doom, Quake, USD \$ 4 million and a bajillion geek points
Achievement Unlocked: Open source advocate, USD \$ 4 million
Quote: "It's done, when it's done."

4 If you owned a computer in the 1990s, it's very likely you have John Carmack to thank for doing more than just doodling in MS Paint. One of the earliest pioneers of core game development, and a co-founder of id Software, he's been responsible for creating games such as Wolfenstein, Doom, Quake and Commander Keen. His work to push 3D graphics and improving the gaming experience have brought him to now helm the position of Chief Technology Officer at Oculus VR. His work to further innovation through sharing and open source software development has led to contributions in Linux based gaming and the broader use of his work in other games like Half Life and Call of Duty. And like all geeks has taken steps towards making space travel fun again with the creation of Armadillo Aerospace. Now, with the innovations in virtual reality technology like the Oculus Rift, it's only a matter of time before we see the second wave of Carmack's genius.



SATYA NADELLA

Abilities: Cloud computing expert, R&D leader
XP Points: 22 years at Microsoft, USD \$45 million net worth
Achievement Unlocked: First Indian CEO of Microsoft, introduced cricket to everyone at Microsoft
Quotes: "I fundamentally believe that if you are not learning new things, you stop doing great and useful things."

5 An Indian is the new Chief Executive Officer of Microsoft. But the mysterious Satya Nadella is more than a nationality now, a symbol of ambition and success for many Indians. No longer will Indian parents have to taunt their kids with statements like "Don't you want to grow up to be like Bill Gates" and instead maybe invoke Satya Nadella. The engineer-of-Hyderabad origin from Manipal Institute of Technology (the other MIT), went to America for a Masters in Computer Science and went on to take up an MBA from Chicago's Booth School of Business. A long term veteran of Microsoft, the 46 year old joined the company in 1992 in the enterprise side of operations. He went on to not only become the executive vice president of the Cloud and Enterprise group in the company but also pioneered its advanced technologies in digital rights management and interactive television, further boosting Microsoft's growth in the high margin world of business solutions as well as consumer centric operations. As he takes the helm of one of the largest technology company, the whole world's eyes will be watching his every move.